

ASPARAGUS & LEMON FETTUCINE

INGREDIENTS

⅔ cup extra-virgin olive oil
1 large bunch asparagus, trimmed, thinly sliced
on a deep diagonal
4 garlic cloves, smashed
Zest of 1 lemon
½ tsp. crushed red pepper flakes
8 large basil leaves
1 lemon juiced
60gms. Parmesan, finely grated (about 1 cup),
plus more for serving

METHOD

Step 1

Cook pasta in a large pot of boiling salted water, stirring occasionally, until al dente. Drain pasta, reserving 1½ cups pasta cooking liquid.

Step 2

Meanwhile, heat oil in a large Dutch oven or other heavy pot over medium-high until shimmering. Add asparagus, season with salt, and cook, stirring often, until just beginning to take on color, about 1 minute.

Step 3

Add garlic, lemon zest, and red pepper flakes and cook, stirring, until fragrant, about 30 seconds. Add the cream and reduce by half.

Step 4

Add lemon juice to half a cup of reserved pasta water, add this along with the pasta and basil to pot with asparagus mixture and return to medium-high heat. Now add 60gms Parmesan and more reserved pasta cooking liquid as needed.

Step 5

Cook, tossing vigorously, but gently and adding more pasta cooking liquid if needed, until sauce is creamy and emulsified and pasta is coated, about 1 minute. Taste and season with more salt if needed. Remove and discard garlic or paste and add back for a bold punchy flavour.

Step 6

Divide pasta among bowls, placing a lemon strip in each, and top with more Parmesan.

THE COOKERY

by The Secret Jozi Chef